

TrueLift

USER MANUAL

Your adaptive strength coach

Plan, adjust and log your routines to progress with sound judgement in every session.

www.truelift.es

Table of contents

1. Welcome to TrueLift
2. Free version and PRO version
3. First steps: set up your routine
4. Language, units and equipment
5. The five tabs
6. Routine tab
7. Your day to day: logging a session
8. Your data is the engine: what to log and why
9. How the app progresses
10. Optional features (PRO)
11. Deload mode
12. Volume tab
13. Progress tab
14. Nutrition tab (PRO)
15. Support tools
16. Sharing your training
17. Backup
18. Recommendations by level
19. Frequently asked questions
20. About the author

1. Welcome to TrueLift

TrueLift is a strength-training app designed so that anyone can follow a serious routine, log their sets and progress with sound judgement, without needing to know anything about sports programming. You train and write down what you do; the app takes care of telling you when and how much to raise the weight, when it is wise to hold back, and how your progress is evolving over time.

The core idea is simple: progress in strength is not about adding weight any old way, but about applying small, sustainable increments at the right moment. TrueLift watches your logs (weight, repetitions, RIR, effort, daily state...) and translates all of it into a clear recommendation for your next session. The better you log, the better it coaches you: in section 8 you will see which data the engine uses and why they matter so much.

This manual walks through the app from end to end: the initial setup, every tab, all the tools, the optional features and the most frequent questions. You do not need to read it all at once; use it as a reference whenever you have doubts about any screen.

Important: TrueLift is a support tool for your training, not a substitute for medical judgement. If you have pain or health concerns, consult a professional.

2. Free version and PRO version

TrueLift is free in its essential part: you can set up your routine, log your sessions, receive the automatic weight increases and track your progress without paying anything. Some advanced features belong to the PRO version, which you can unlock with whichever payment option you prefer: subscription, annual payment or lifetime payment.

What each version includes

Feature	Free	PRO
Log sessions and automatic progression	✓	✓
Cardio, plate calculator and warm-up	✓	✓
Rest timer with alarm	✓	✓
Floating timer over other apps (Android)	✓	✓
Weekly volume and frequency	✓	✓
Progress, personal records and performance	✓	✓
Strength level ("Your level")	✓	✓
Share workouts and monthly report	✓	✓
Backups	✓	✓
Swap one exercise for another	✓	✓
Language (ES / EN / PT-BR) and kg / lb units	✓	✓
Manual deload mode	—	✓
Adjust sets, RIR, repetitions and rest	—	✓

Feature	Free	PRO
Customize your routine at pattern level	—	✓
Rename and reorder sessions and exercises	—	✓
Create new exercises in the library	—	✓
Export your routine to Excel and import routines	—	✓
PRO routines ready to train	—	✓
Create your routine with AI (questionnaire + prompt)	—	✓
Top set + back-offs	—	✓
Auto-regulation (daily state)	—	✓
HRV (heart rate variability)	—	✓
Diet phase (deficit / surplus)	—	✓
Automatically suggested deload	—	✓
Readiness-to-train indicator (0–100)	—	✓
Fatigue and pain by body region (lower / upper body)	—	✓
Reordering test for plateaus	—	✓
Cardio load integrated into fatigue signals	—	✓
Nutrition tab: weight tracking and weekly card	—	✓
Season planner (bulk / maintenance / cut)	—	✓
Body fat estimator and measurement history	—	✓
Food library and adjustments in grams	—	✓
Performance monitor and stimulus protection	—	✓
Refeed and deload coordinated with training	—	✓

In the free version, the diet phase is fixed at Maintenance, and auto-regulation and HRV are disabled. The Nutrition tab does not exist either: the bottom bar has four tabs instead of five. Everything else works normally.

Is PRO worth it? The free version gives you a complete progression engine that decides from what you do in the gym. The PRO version also takes into account what happens outside it: your sleep, your stress, your pain (and its region), your HRV, your diet phase and your cardio load. With those signals, the engine does not only decide how much to add: it decides when to push, when to hold back and when to protect you with a deload. And with the nutrition layer it also governs the other half of the equation — your weight — keeping diet and training pulling in the same direction. If you take your training seriously, that difference compounds over months of progress. And you can try it free for 28 days.

Free 28-day PRO trial

You can try all the PRO features for 28 days, free and without entering any payment details. When you try to use a PRO feature (or from the settings, in the PRO section that opens from the first entry of the screen), you will see the PRO version screen with the Try 28 days free button. Tapping it immediately activates all the advanced features, including the Nutrition tab.

- During the trial, the PRO section shows the days you have left, and every time you open the app a notice reminds you of it with the OK and Buy PRO version buttons.
- The start cover switches to the PRO version while the trial is active.
- When the 28 days end, the PRO features lock again and the app returns to free mode. Your routine and your history are not lost: those advanced options simply stop being available until you purchase the full version.

The trial can be used only once per user.

Buying the PRO version

To get the PRO features, tap **Buy PRO** on the PRO version screen. All payments are handled by Google Play, with the usual methods of your account (card, Google Pay, carrier billing, etc.). You can choose between three options: subscription (recurring payment you can cancel whenever you want), annual payment (a full year of PRO) and lifetime payment (a single payment that never expires). The price of each option is shown on the purchase screen itself. Once activated, your purchase is tied to your Google account: if you change phones or reinstall, tap **Restore purchase** and it will be reactivated without paying again.

3. First steps: set up your routine

The first time you open TrueLift you land on the **Set up your routine** screen. Here you define your starting point. You can return to it at any time with the settings icon (top right).

For whom?

Choose Man or Woman. This selects the most suitable base routine model as a starting point (you can customize it later).

Progression system

Decide how you want to progress:

- **Simple linear:** fixed repetitions. When you complete all sets with the target number of repetitions and the expected RIR, the app raises the weight in the next session. It is the ideal option if you have been training for less than two years, because it lets you increase frequently.
- **Double progression:** you work with a repetition range (for example 8–12). You accumulate repetitions with the same weight until you complete all sets at the top of the range; then the app gives you the new weight. It is ideal when linear progression has stalled.

Training days per week

Choose between 2 and 5 days. The routine structure (what is trained each day) adjusts automatically to the number of days chosen.

Your body weight

Select your body weight with the wheel. It is used in bodyweight or weighted exercises (pull-ups, dips, push-ups), where the weight you move includes your own body, so that strength estimates are realistic. Keep it up to date: the engine uses it both to suggest loads and to measure your real progress in those exercises (also in assisted ones), and it also feeds your strength-level classification in Progress.

If you turn on the nutrition layer (section 14), your body weight is updated on its own from your daily weigh-ins and this wheel is disabled while the module is on.

When you finish, tap **Continue with this routine** to enter the app.

4. Language, units and equipment

Take a moment in the settings screen: it determines whether the weight increases TrueLift proposes are actually loadable with your equipment, and whether the app speaks your language and your units.

Language

You can use the app in **Spanish, English or Portuguese (Brazil)**. The change is immediate and affects the entire interface, the engine messages and the help tips.

Units: kg or lb

Choose whether you want to see weights in kilograms or pounds. Internally the app always keeps your data with full precision, so switching units does not rewrite your history or break the suggestions: you will simply see everything converted, including the plate settings (for example, 1.25 kg plates are shown as 2.5 lb plates).

1.25 kg (2.5 lb) plates

Turn it on if you have pairs of 1.25 kg plates (assumed unlimited). It allows finer load jumps on the barbell: instead of going up 2.5 kg per side, you can adjust by 1.25 kg per side.

Microloading (fractional plates)

Microloading has a **master switch** ("Enable microloading"), off by default. With it off, fractional plates take no part in suggestions or load rounding. If you turn it on, specify:

- **Weight of the smallest plate:** the value of the fractional plate you own (for example 0.5, 0.75 or 1 kg).
- **How many per side:** from 1 to 4, or Unlimited. This matters because, if you only have one pair of 0.5 kg plates, the app will not suggest an increase that requires three per side.
- **Include microloading on dumbbells:** turn it on if you also use fractional plates (magnetic or strapped) on your dumbbells, to allow smaller jumps than your gym's dumbbell increment.
- **Forgetfulness reminder:** if you enable it, when you finish the last exercise that uses microplates the app will ask whether you have picked them up. Very handy so you don't leave your small plates at the gym.

Standard plates (2.5 / 5 / 10 / 20 kg, and the 1.25 kg ones if you enable them) are considered unlimited.

Dumbbell increment

Enter the weight difference between one dumbbell and the next in your gym (for example, 2 kg). It is used to compute the target weight in dumbbell exercises, so that the suggested weight actually exists on your rack.

Countdown between sets

If you enable it, when you log the repetitions of a set the rest timer until the next one starts automatically. You can disable it if you prefer to control rests yourself.

Floating timer (Android)

With the countdown enabled, on Android you can also take your rest outside the app. With the **Floating timer** on, when you leave TrueLift a small capsule appears on top of whatever app you are using — the browser, your music, a chat — showing the rest time left. You can drag it wherever it does not get in the way and, when you want to go back, tap it: it takes you straight to TrueLift, to the set you were logging. Inside the app the capsule hides itself, because there you already have the timer in view.

The first time you turn it on, Android will ask for the special **Display over other apps** permission. It is a system setting, so the app takes you there and waits for you to come back. If you do not grant it, the switch will not stay on and you will see a notice explaining why.

While the rest is running you will also see a notification with the remaining time and a button to stop it. It is not decorative: it is what stops the system freezing the countdown while the app is in the background and, thanks to it, **the alarm sounds even with the screen off or the phone locked**. The sound comes from the app itself, so it ducks your music instead of cutting it and is heard even with Do Not Disturb on.

When it ends you also get a rest-complete notice. On the phone it arrives silently on purpose, so that it does not duplicate the siren that is already sounding.

Alerts on your smartwatch. That rest-complete notice is an ordinary system notification, so if your watch shows TrueLift notifications you will get it on your wrist too. The app uses two separate notification channels — one for the running countdown and one for the final alert — so you can allow just the second one and have your watch buzz when the set is over without bothering you throughout the rest. Where you set this up depends on your watch: it is done in its companion app (Wear OS, Galaxy Wearable, Garmin Connect, Zepp...), not inside TrueLift, and the exact behaviour varies by model.

The switch only appears if your device supports it, and it depends on **Countdown between sets**: if you turn the countdown off, the floating timer goes off with it. On iPhone the countdown and the alarm work normally, but the floating capsule is not available yet.

Help tips and mini-glossary

With this switch on, you will see small information icons throughout the app (next to RIR, deload, e1RM, HRV, diet phase, strength levels...). Tapping them opens a short explanation of the concept. If you already master the terminology, you can hide them.

5. The five tabs

The bottom bar has five tabs when the PRO version is active — the fifth one is Nutrition — and four in the free version. This is the overview; each one is detailed further on.

- **Routine:** your training plan. Here you see the days, the exercises, the sets, the repetitions, the RIR and the rest, and you can customize it.
- **Volume:** how many effective sets you do per muscle group per week and with what frequency, with a color reference.
- **Log:** the heart of the app. Here you record each session and log cardio. When you open the app it lands on this tab with the next session already pre-selected.
- **Progress:** charts and records. Tonnage, estimated 1RM, per-session evolution, your strength level, personal records, performance, recent readiness and the monthly report.
- **Nutrition (PRO):** the nutrition layer. You log your weight every day and, once a week, the app tells you whether you should adjust something in your diet or your activity. It only appears with the PRO version and with the module turned on.

At the top right, at any time, you have quick access to the plate calculator (dumbbell icon) and the settings (gear icon).

What about the Author tab? Information about the author, the links and PRO version activation now open from the settings (gear icon): it is the first entry of the screen, in the brand colour.

6. Routine tab

The Routine tab shows your plan organized by days/sessions (upper tabs). Each exercise appears in a card with its movement pattern, its muscle group and its parameters.

Actions on each exercise

- **Change exercise** (free): replace the exercise with another option of the same pattern and group. Useful if your gym lacks a specific machine.
- **Change pattern** (PRO): changes the movement pattern of the slot (for example, from horizontal push to vertical push).
- **Sets, RIR, Reps and Rest** (PRO): adjust each parameter with the + / – buttons. In the free version these controls show the PRO screen.
- **Remove exercise** (trash can): deletes the exercise from that day.

Under each day you have **Add exercise** (adds a new line to that session) and **Restore original routine** (undoes all your changes and returns to the preset routine).

Rename and reorder (PRO)

Each session has a **Rename session** button: you can change the day's name (for example, call it "Push" or "Legs A"). Renaming keeps that session's history so you don't lose your progress.

In addition, with PRO you can **reorder**: press and hold an exercise for two seconds to drag it to another position within the day, and do the same with the day tabs to change their order. Order is not part of

the progression's identity: reordering does not alter your history, your baselines or your progression anchors.

Library and Excel templates

- **New exercise in the library (PRO):** create your own exercise (with its name, pattern and group) to use in your routines.
- **Download template (free):** you get an Excel template to plan your routine comfortably on the computer.
- **Export your routine to Excel (PRO):** download your current routine already filled into the Excel template. That way you can use it as a base, rearrange exercises, sets, repetitions, RIR and rests comfortably on the computer and, when you finish, import it back.
- **Import (PRO):** load that Excel template already filled in and the app rebuilds your routine from it. It closes the loop: you export your routine, edit it comfortably in Excel and re-import it so TrueLift applies it exactly as it is.

PRO routines ready to train (PRO)

If you have PRO, you don't need to create your routine from scratch: the app can automatically download a collection of PRO routines already designed and ready to train. They are complete, straightforward plans meant to cover practically any situation: for men and for women, for different numbers of training days per week, for those with lots of equipment or very little, and for those with more time per session or who need to train in less time. The idea is that you find an option that fits your context without prior work: you pick the one that suits you best, load it and start logging. From there it progresses like any other routine, and you can keep adjusting it or export it to Excel if you want to fine-tune it.

Create your routine with AI (PRO)

Can't find a routine that fits you? The app can create a **prompt with your needs** so that an external AI (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini...) generates a personalized routine that you will then import into TrueLift. The process:

- Answer the questionnaire (sex, age, experience, goal, days and session length, muscles to prioritize, aches, progression system, preferred structure, equipment you don't have and exercises to avoid) and the app will generate a tailored prompt.
- Export your routine to Excel from "Routine actions → Export or create your routine". That file is the template the AI must fill in.
- Open your trusted AI, paste the prompt and attach the Excel file in the same message.
- Get the routine into the Excel: if the AI returns the filled file, use it as is; if it gives you a table, copy the values into the Day 1-5 tabs. The Excel dropdowns will warn you if a value is not valid.
- Come back to the app and import the file from "Routine actions → Import routine from file".

Before using AI: the best option is almost always a routine from the app itself (the built-in ones or the PRO routines), designed and tested to work with its progression engine. And always review the resulting routine: the external AI does not know your technique or your history. When in doubt, less volume and more margin (RIR).

Top set + back-offs (PRO)

What it is. The top set is your strongest set of the day: the first set of the exercise, with the highest weight and the lowest RIR, the one that marks your level and from which progression is derived. The back-offs (or back sets) are the sets that come afterwards, with a slightly lower weight —the back-off percentage you chose— to accumulate quality volume without repeating the maximum load. The idea is to squeeze the most out of one truly demanding set and then reduce the load a bit to keep adding effective work with good technique. In practice: you give your all in the top set and complete the back-offs with margin.

In the routine editor, the main exercises (“big” pattern) show a “Top set + back-offs” switch. When you enable it, two settings appear: **back-off %** (from 5 to 30 %, in steps of 5) and **back RIR** (0-4). Set 1 is the top set; the rest are back-offs.

In the log, the weight field is renamed “Kg (top)”. Each back-off has its own kg field, auto-filled as $\text{top} \times (1 - \%)$ and rounded to the weight loadable with your plates. If you change the top kg, the back-offs follow; if you edit a back-off manually, that field is respected. The target RIR of the back-offs is auto-filled separately, also applying the adjustments for deload or the day’s state.

Progression and metrics: only the top set sets the exercise’s progression (repetition target, e1RM, plateaus and “same bar” records). Back-offs count toward session performance, intra-session fatigue, automatic deload and tonnage. Back-offs are not meant to progress by themselves: their weight is fixed relative to the top set and you only need to complete repetitions until your target RIR. Even so, all sets —top and back— are taken into account to compute the session’s performance.

Excel: the template includes three columns on each day: H “Top+Back (yes/no)” with a dropdown, I “back-off %” (5-30) and J “back RIR” (0-6), plus a note in Instructions. When exporting, TrueLift fills them in; when importing, it reads them. If they are empty or say “no”, they are interpreted as straight sets, so old templates can be imported without changes.

7. Your day to day: logging a session

The Log tab is where you will spend most of your time. When you open the app it is already positioned on the next session due (the one after the last you saved).

Before starting

- At the top you see the selected session and that session’s week. Each session type progresses independently.
- For each exercise, the app shows you the **Target** (sets $\times$ reps $\cdot$ RIR) and, below, **Last time** (the weight and reps you did last time), so you have an immediate reference.
- The suggested weight comes pre-filled automatically and is always a weight you can load with your configured equipment.

An important detail: “Last time” always shows your latest real session. If that session cannot anchor the progression (because it was a deload session, it was saved on an amber/red day, or it was trained at reduced intensity due to fatigue), the app explains it right below, in amber, and tells you which full-intensity session the suggestion is based on. So you will never wonder why the app “ignores” a session: it always tells you.

Recording the session

For each set, write the repetitions you did and the RIR (reps in reserve: how many you had left before failure). Enter the weight used (you can leave 0 in exercises without external load). A progress bar shows the percentage of the plan you reached, with a reference margin.

What is RIR? It is a simple way of measuring effort: an RIR of 2 means you could have done 2 more repetitions before failing. Recording it correctly is essential for the progression to be accurate. Be honest: an inflated RIR ends in increases that later don't work out. And if one day you don't log it, the app protects itself and applies only a prudent minimal increase until it gets that signal back (it will remind you in the suggestion message).

Log the real RIR of every set. Don't write the same value "from memory" for the whole table: enter the RIR of each set separately, exactly as it was. The app reads set by set, not a rough average, and each RIR influences how it interprets your effort, the estimate of your strength and the progression it will propose. In straight sets the goal is clear: hit the repetition target in every set —and, in double progression, reach the top of the range in all of them— and record the true RIR of each. That is what lets the engine control your progress precisely; two sessions with the same reps but different RIR lead to different decisions. One detail that makes a difference: don't do more repetitions than planned to "force" a lower RIR. If your target is 3×8-10 at RIR 1 and in the first set you reach 10 but still have one left (RIR 2), record 10 reps and RIR 2; don't do an eleventh repetition to bring it down to RIR 1. Logging the real RIR —even if it is higher than expected— is exactly the signal the engine needs. With that in mind, the rule is simple: you progress when you meet the repetition target in every set and, in addition, the overall RIR is equal to or higher than the target. That confirms the weight is under control and it's time to increase; if the overall RIR falls below the target, even if you hit the reps, the engine understands there is still consolidation to do.

Exercise unavailable and notes

Machine busy or equipment broken? You can mark an exercise as **Unavailable** that day (also when editing a saved session). The entry is kept as a record, but it does not count toward performance, volume, plateaus or progression, and it does not replace your last valid workout as a reference. In addition, each exercise accepts free-text **notes** (sensations, technique, grips...), saved with the session.

Saving and messages

Before saving you can rate the session's effort (RPE, from 1 to 10). It is optional and only counts if you touch it, but it is worth it: the engine uses it to adjust the next increase and monitor your accumulated fatigue (more detail in section 8).

When you tap **Save session**, TrueLift analyzes what you did and replies with clear messages:

- A performance message assessing how the session went compared to what was expected.
- A new-record notice if you improved your best estimated 1RM in a main (multi-joint) exercise.
- A congratulation for streaks if you chain complete training weeks.
- Messages with context: if you log on an amber or red day, the app reminds you that somewhat lower performance is expected; and in a deload week it confirms it is not evaluating performance (that is what's expected, not an error). If fatigue affects only one body region (for example, legs), the messages tell you so: "today there are fatigue signals affecting the lower body".

If you have the timer enabled between sets, logging each set starts the rest countdown.

Rest timer and alarm

The timer counts the rest between sets and sounds an alarm when it ends, even if the screen is off or you are listening to music (the alarm mixes with the audio, it doesn't cut it). The screen stays on while the countdown runs so you can see the remaining time.

If you also enable the floating timer (section 4), on Android your rest follows you outside the app: a draggable capsule over whatever app you are using, which takes you back to TrueLift when you tap it.

Logging cardio

With the **Log cardio** button you record your cardio sessions: choose a type (or write your own name), the duration in minutes and the intensity or effort (RPE, from 1 to 10). Cardio appears marked in your history and in the calendar.

Cardio is not a mere note: with the duration and effort, the engine computes your weekly cardio load and compares it with what is usual for you. A week clearly more demanding than normal counts as a fatigue signal and, with auto-regulation (PRO), can prompt a deload suggestion. Log all your cardio sessions with realistic data, especially if you combine strength and endurance.

History

Below the log you have your session history (a list that loads efficiently even if you have hundreds of entries). If you logged in real time, each session also stores its duration. In each session you can:

- **Share:** generates an attractive image of the workout, ready for social media.
- **Edit:** fix the weight, repetitions, RIR, notes or date of an already saved session.
- **Delete:** erase that session.

You can also **Export to Excel** the entire history, or **Delete the whole history** (with double confirmation, for safety).

8. Your data is the engine: what to log and why

TrueLift doesn't guess: it learns from you. Every recommendation you see in the app —the suggested weight, the message when saving, the deload notice— comes from an engine that analyzes your logs and turns them into decisions. The consequence is direct: the quality of what the app recommends depends on the quality of what you log. This section tells you which signals the engine watches and what your training gains with each one.

We won't go into the formulas (that logic is private), but into what matters to you: which data the engine uses, what it uses them for and why it is worth logging them well.

Weight and repetitions: the foundation of everything

Every set you record feeds the estimate of your real strength (the estimated 1RM). The engine doesn't rely only on your best set: it combines the best one with the session as a whole, so that one occasionally optimistic set doesn't inflate the recommendation. With that estimate it decides whether it's time to increase, how much, and when it's better to consolidate.

In bodyweight or weighted exercises (pull-ups, dips, push-ups), the engine computes your strength using your body weight plus the added load —also in assisted exercises, where the load can be negative—. That is why it is important to keep your body weight up to date in the settings: if it changes and you don't update it, your estimates and your progress chart will drift without you noticing.

RIR: the small piece of data that changes things the most

RIR (reps in reserve) tells the engine how far from failure you are working. With it, the app adjusts each increase: if you still have reps to spare, it can be a bit more ambitious; if you are at the limit, it protects you. Two pieces of advice:

- **Be honest.** An inflated RIR translates into unrealistic strength estimates and weights that later don't work. It is better to fall short than to overshoot.
- **Don't leave it blank.** If one day you don't log the RIR, the app doesn't break, but it turns cautious: it will apply only a minimal increase until it recovers that signal. Logging less will never give you more aggressive recommendations; it will give you more conservative ones, by definition.

Session effort (RPE)

When saving the session you can rate your overall effort from 1 to 10 (RPE). It is optional, and only counts if you touch it: the app never makes up a value for you. If you log it, the engine uses it for two things: modulating the next increase (meeting the target easily is not the same as meeting it in agony) and monitoring your accumulated internal load, one of the signals that anticipates fatigue before it shows in your weights.

Cardio counts too

With the duration and effort (1–10) you log, the engine computes your weekly cardio load and compares it with what is usual for you. A cardio week clearly more demanding than normal counts as a fatigue signal and, with auto-regulation (PRO), can even prompt a deload suggestion. If you combine strength and endurance, log all your cardio with realistic data: it is the only way for the app to consider your full training, and not just half of it.

Log in the moment, not from memory

Record each set as you do it. RIR remembered hours later is much less reliable, and the app also automatically stores the duration of your sessions when you log in real time (you will see it in your history). Consistent logging with the same criteria is worth more than a perfect one once in a while: the engine learns from your patterns, and patterns need consistency.

How fatigue is computed

The app doesn't measure your fatigue with a sensor: it infers it from the signals you already log, always comparing them with what is usual for you, not with an absolute value. Four things weigh the most: the real RIR of your sets (training session after session closer to failure than planned accumulates fatigue), your performance relative to your baseline (repeatedly underperforming), the session effort (RPE) you log when saving, and your weekly cardio load. With PRO auto-regulation, your daily state (sleep, stress, aches, energy) and HRV are added. The engine doesn't react to one isolated bad day: it watches the trend across several sessions, so a one-off dip won't hold you back, but a sustained accumulation slows the pace of increases and, if pronounced, triggers the deload

suggestion. Back-offs and tonnage also feed that internal-load reading. That's why, the more complete and honest your logs, the better the app distinguishes between "you are strong and can push" and "you need to recover".

With PRO, the engine sees twice as much

Everything above works in the free version. The PRO version adds the signals from outside the gym: your sleep, your stress, your aches (with their region), your energy, your HRV and your diet phase. With them, the engine doesn't just decide how much to increase: it decides when to accelerate, when to brake and when to protect you. Every extra piece of data you log is a finer adjustment. You can try it free for 28 days.

9. How the app progresses

You don't have to compute anything: TrueLift decides the load of your next session from your logs. Broadly, this is how it works from your point of view:

- If you meet the target (all sets with the expected repetitions and RIR), the app proposes raising the weight next time. The increment is small and proportional to the exercise: more in the big basics, less in isolation work.
- If you fall short, it keeps the weight to consolidate before increasing again.
- The increase is not blind: it takes into account how your last session really went. If you met the target but at the limit (very high effort or just-enough performance), the increase will be smaller; if you were clearly comfortable, it will be somewhat larger. When the app decides to be prudent, it tells you in the message itself ("moderate increase...").
- **Anti-plateau:** if you chain several sessions without completing the target at the same weight, the app first warns you that the next attempt is decisive and, if you remain stuck, proposes a small step back in load to gain momentum and climb again by accumulating repetitions. It's what a good coach would do: staying at the same weight for months is no longer an option.
- **Reordering test (PRO):** before the step back, if the stuck exercise is not the first of its day, the app tries one session moving it to the first slot, fresh. Sometimes the plateau is accumulated fatigue from the previous exercises and not a real ceiling. If doing it first unblocks the exercise, it returns to its place and you keep progressing without stepping back; if it still doesn't work, the step back is applied and the app confirms it was a real ceiling. The rest of that day's exercises train normally and their progression is unaffected.
- If you come back after a break of several weeks, the app doesn't demand you continue where you left off: it proposes resuming with prudence and "relearning" your real level in a few sessions, without marking weak sessions compared to your old self. The longer the break, the gentler the return.
- Several days rated only as "so-so" with PRO auto-regulation? The engine doesn't freeze: it warns you to check sleep and stress, and meanwhile keeps progressing prudently with the available information.
- Your history is stable: each session is evaluated with the criteria of the day you saved it. Changing the diet phase later does not rewrite your past sessions.

- The proposed weight can always be loaded with your equipment: on the barbell it rises in increments of the smallest plate placed on both sides; on machines, plate by plate; with dumbbells, according to the increment you specified (and your microplates, if enabled).
- Each session type progresses separately, so if an exercise appears on two different days, it advances independently in each.

In double progression, instead of raising the weight every time, you first accumulate repetitions within the range; when you reach the maximum in all sets, the app gives you the weight increase and the range restarts.

10. Optional features (PRO)

These features are optional: the app works without them. They are designed for those who want to adjust training to their state and context. All of them belong to the PRO version.

Auto-regulation (daily state)

It lets you record each day how you are: sleep, mood/energy, muscle soreness, stress, joint pain and illness. With that information, the app can adjust the session to your real readiness: if you accumulate several bad days it will take it into account and adapt the training. If it detects relevant fatigue signals, it will suggest a deload which, if you accept, will regulate training in deload mode for one or two weeks. And if one day you don't record your state, the app does not assume you are fine —absence of data is not a good signal—: it will remind you before suggesting increases. There is only one entry per day: saving again replaces the previous one.

How to score sleep and mood. Always score relative to your normality, not to an ideal. If you slept the way you usually sleep —even if you feel it is “never perfect”— that is a 4, not a 3: the 3 is for nights truly worse than normal and the 5 for exceptional rest. The same goes for mood and energy: an ordinary day, with nothing standing out negatively, is a 4. Recording your normal day as a 4 is not settling (keep trying to sleep and recover better), but it prevents the engine from reading a dip that doesn't actually exist and slowing you down without reason.

Muscle soreness is not joint pain. Distinguish the two well when recording discomfort. Soreness (DOMS) is that diffuse feeling in the muscle itself one or two days after training, especially after new exercises or higher volume: it is normal, part of the process, and should not be recorded as pain. Joint pain is something else: it is sharp or localized in a joint (knee, shoulder, elbow, hip...), usually appears during the movement and indicates something is off. That one you should record, always specifying the affected region, so the app protects only the exercises of that region without holding back the rest. If you record simple soreness as pain, the system will over-limit you; if you ignore real joint pain, it won't be able to look after you.

Fatigue and pain by region: lower and upper body

Both joint pain and strong soreness are recorded with their **region**: general, lower body or upper body. The app classifies each exercise by its region (by muscle group and pattern) and applies protection only where it belongs: a knee issue will slow down your squat, but not your bench press; 4/4 leg soreness will not raise the RIR of your presses. Systemic signals (sleep, mood, stress, HRV, illness) affect both regions. The log messages tell you the affected region (“Joint pain (lower body)”, “today there are

fatigue signals affecting the upper body”), and in the recent-readiness history in Progress each non-green day shows its region with a letter: **G** (general), **I** (lower body) or **S** (upper body).

HRV (heart rate variability)

Within auto-regulation you can enter each day your average nightly HRV (whatever your watch or band reports) and, optionally, your nightly resting heart rate. It counts as one more signal of your daily state and your recovery relative to training. If one night’s reading is unreliable (bad measurement), you can discard it and it won’t count.

Optionally you can set a manual reference band (the one your watch gives, if you already have history); over time, the app learns your personal band from your own measurements and tells you how many nights are left to activate the automatic band.

The engine only reacts to the **sustained signal**, not to one isolated bad night: it takes at least two low nights in a row, or a multi-day trend below your band, for HRV to modulate training; one good night breaks the streak instantly, and the modulation switches itself off as soon as the average recovers. It is a feature for advanced users: if you don’t measure your HRV, leave it off.

State to train and readiness (0–100)

When you use auto-regulation, the app summarizes your availability in two mutually consistent ways: a **state banner** (green, amber or red) with the day’s reasons, and a **readiness-to-train** indicator from 0 to 100 with a color ring by bands (0–39 red, 40–69 amber, 70–100 green). Tap it to see the breakdown of which signals (sleep, stress, HRV, recent performance, accumulated training and cardio load...) are adding or subtracting. If your recent performance is weak, the banner itself tells you (“Recent performance weak: today we keep loads...”), even if your questionnaire for the day is good.

Diet phase

Indicate which nutritional phase you are in so the app modulates the aggressiveness of the progression:

- **Deficit:** you are eating below your maintenance (cutting). The app is more conservative with increases.
- **Maintenance:** balanced behavior (it is the default value).
- **Surplus:** you eat above maintenance (bulking). The app is somewhat more permissive with increases.

The effect intensifies with the weeks you spend in the selected phase. If you don’t control your diet, leave it at Maintenance: it is the neutral option and the one that avoids misreadings. In the free version it stays fixed at Maintenance.

With the nutrition layer turned on (section 14), the phase is no longer chosen here: it is set by the current block of your season plan and updates on its own when a block ends. The effect on progression is exactly the same; the only thing that changes is who decides the phase.

11. Deload mode

A deload is a light week to recover: fewer sets, higher RIR, around 10 % less load and progression on pause. It is not losing progress, it is protecting it.

- You can activate it in the settings (**Deload mode**, a PRO feature). The app notifies you when the week is complete and lets you end it or keep it one more week; if you keep it, it deactivates itself when it ends.
- When the deload closes, progression resumes from the weights you had before starting it, not from the reduced weights of the light week.
- With auto-regulation enabled, the app can also **suggest a deload** when it detects signs of accumulated fatigue, a performance drop, many consecutive days in bad shape (even if your numbers don't show it yet) or a cardio week far above usual. Every so many weeks, it also invites you to honestly assess whether your body needs one —only if you have trained regularly enough to need it.
- During the deload, when saving each session the app confirms it is not evaluating your performance nor using that week for your comparisons. It is intentional: the light week doesn't pollute your statistics or your progress.
- The automatic suggestions are sensible: after finishing a deload there is a grace period without new suggestions (the small dip on return is normal and expected), and pain only counts as a reason if it is recent, not because of an episode already resolved.

12. Volume tab

This tab tells you whether you are training each muscle group with the right volume. It shows two things:

- **Effective sets per week** per muscle group (the exercise's primary group counts $\times 1$ and secondary ones $\times 0.5$), according to your current selection of exercises and sets.
- **Weekly frequency**: how many days you train each group.

The color reference guides you at a glance (example for men; for women the values are slightly different, as they tolerate more volume):

Sets / week	Meaning
4 or fewer	Too low
5 – 9	Effective minimum / maintenance
10 – 20	Target zone (start at the lower end)
21 or more	Very high — watch your recovery

As for frequency, training a group two or more days per week is usually preferable for most goals.

13. Progress tab

Here you see how you evolve over time. It includes, among others:

- **Last session's tonnage**: the total kilos moved (weight $\times$ repetitions).
- **Estimated 1RM**: an estimate of your one-repetition maximum from your last set, computed with a standard formula that takes RIR into account and protected against very high-rep sets, which are the noisiest.

- **Estimated e1RM per session:** the evolution of your best estimated 1RM in each session, to see the trend. Essential to know whether you are really progressing.
- **Your level:** your strength level per exercise, comparing your best estimated 1RM with your body weight (strength-to-weight ratio) according to common standards by sex: Beginner, Novice, Intermediate, Advanced and Elite. It is a guide: useful to know your starting point and celebrate milestones, not to compare yourself with anyone.
- **Recent readiness (PRO):** a summary of your recent daily-state days (green, amber and red). Today's cell is computed live and always matches the log banner; non-green days show the affected region with its letter (G general, L lower body, S upper body), with a legend below.
- **Personal records:** your best estimated 1RM per exercise. Only the big multi-joint lifts are listed (squats, deadlift, presses, pull-ups/pulldowns and rows), which are the ones that define your real strength.
- **HRV per day (PRO):** the evolution of your HRV measurements.
- **Performance:** a chart telling you whether you are performing above or below your baseline, showing the thresholds.
- **Duration of your sessions:** if you log in real time, the app records by itself how long your workouts last and you can see their evolution.

From this tab you can also generate the **Monthly report**: an HTML summary with your trained days, compliance, sessions, tonnage, repetitions and e1RM evolution, ready to share or save.

14. Nutrition tab (PRO)

TrueLift includes an optional nutrition layer that works alongside your training. The idea is simple: **you weigh in, the app adjusts**. You log your weight every day and, once a week, the app tells you whether you should change something in your diet or your activity so that your weight moves at the rate you planned. You do not log meals, you do not count calories, and there is no food database to fill in.

It is a PRO feature. With PRO active it appears as the fifth tab of the bottom bar; without PRO the module does not exist. You can turn it on and off whenever you like: turning it off deletes nothing.

What it does and what it does not do

- **It does:** track your weight, filter out day-to-day noise and work out your real rate of change. Once a week it compares that rate with the one you are after and, if needed, proposes an adjustment.
- **It does:** translate that adjustment into grams of your own foods, not just abstract calories.
- **It does:** coordinate with your training. It protects the stimulus if your performance drops, and lines refeeds up with deloads.
- **It does not:** log what you eat, score foods, split daily macros or give you streaks to break.
- **It does not:** create a diet or a nutrition plan, and it does not check whether your food intake is complete or balanced.

Before turning it on: requirements and notice

When you turn the module on you will see a notice you have to read and accept. It is worth taking seriously, because it defines who this is for and who it is not for:

- **It is for healthy adults.** Do not use it if you are under 18, pregnant or breastfeeding, have or have had an eating disorder, are underweight, have a disease or medical condition, or take medication that may affect weight, metabolism or nutritional needs. Consult a qualified healthcare professional first.
- **You need a reasonably structured and consistent way of eating.** The app does not measure what you eat: its suggestions are adjustments relative to your average intake last week. You do not need to know your calorie intake in absolute terms, but you do need to be able to say whether this week you ate roughly like the last one. If your eating is irregular, do not turn the loop on.
- **Estimates can be wrong.** Weighing errors, water or glycogen changes, medication or illness all skew them. The app does not diagnose, prevent or treat disease, and it does not guarantee results.
- **You decide.** The app does not change your food intake by itself: disregard any suggestion that conflicts with professional advice or that is not right for you.
- **Stop if something feels wrong.** Stop following the suggestions and seek professional help if you develop discomfort, dizziness, weakness, menstrual changes, concerning weight loss or gain, or any other symptom.

Your details, just once

Tapping Activate opens a short three-step form. You fill it in once, and you can come back to it whenever you want with **Edit my details**.

- **Profile:** height, sex, strength training experience and an estimate of your body fat %. All four are used to project your season and to bound how fast you can safely progress. Body fat % is required, but you do not need to know it beforehand: the app helps you estimate it.
- **Foods:** optional. You can skip it and add them later; if you enter none, the app works with a small list of basic foods.
- **Alerts and safety:** this is where you accept the notice and decide whether you want reminders. Approximate baseline intake is optional: leave it empty if you do not know it.

The phase is not chosen here — that comes from the season planner — and your body weight is not asked for either: while the module is on, it governs it from your weigh-ins.

Estimating your body fat %

From the form, and also from the tab itself, you can open the estimator. It offers three methods; pick the one you can do today:

- **Circumferences:** with a tape measure at neck and waist (and hips for women), standing, without compressing the tape, fasted and relaxed. The most precise of the three.
- **Gallery:** compare yourself with a set of reference silhouettes and pick the one that looks most like you. Do not look for a perfect match.
- **Direct:** if you have a figure from a bioimpedance scale, a DEXA scan or skinfolds, enter it as is.

Whichever method you use, it is guidance with a typical margin of several percentage points, not a clinical measurement. Do not chase the decimal: what really matters is **always repeating the same method under the same conditions**, because what the app analyses is how the figure changes over

time. Every so often the tab will remind you to estimate it again; keeping it fresh improves the projections and the margin the app works with.

Your food library

It exists so the weekly recommendation is not "eat 200 kcal less" but something you can apply without thinking: "cut 60 g of dry rice". Six to eight foods you eat daily are enough.

For each food you are asked for the name, the kcal per 100 g from its label, whether you weigh it dry or cooked, its main macronutrient and the smallest adjustment in grams you want to be suggested. There is no food database: your numbers are what count.

Watch out for the weighing method, which is the most common mistake: 100 g of dry rice is about 300 g once cooked. Declare one of the two and always weigh it the same way.

The season planner

The planner is where you design your season and also the **only place where your phase is defined**. You chain blocks — Bulk, Maintenance and Cut — and your current phase comes out of that plan.

For each block you choose three things: the type, the start and end dates, and the percentage of your body weight you want to change per week. A colour code guides you on that rate based on your body fat % and your training experience: green is recommended, amber reasonable and red aggressive. The chart shows you the projected outcome at the end of the season — weight, lean mass and body fat % — and recalculates instantly every time you change something.

You do not have to plan the whole year: you can stick to the next phase and add blocks later. When a block ends, the app moves into the next one on its own and announces it with a card you close with Understood. If you do not have a plan yet, the module stays at maintenance — it tracks your weight but does not propose raising or lowering calories — and invites you to create one.

The phase card on the tab is read-only: it tells you which state you are in, at what rate, and your estimated weight, body fat % and lean mass from the start to the end of the block. To change any of those, go to the planner.

Weighing yourself every day

This is your only daily task. Weigh yourself ideally fasted, after using the bathroom, before drinking and naked. The exact time matters less than **always repeating the same conditions**.

A single day's weight goes up and down because of water, salt, glycogen, the menstrual cycle or what you had for dinner. That is why the app does not look at that isolated number, but at your **trend weight**: the line that filters out that noise and shows where you are really heading. You will see both on the chart: the point for each weigh-in and the trend line.

If you skip a day, nothing happens. And if you weighed yourself but forgot to enter it, use **Another day** to log it with its correct date. Each day takes a single weigh-in; if you get it wrong, edit or delete it from the list of recent weigh-ins. If the figure is far from the previous one, the app asks you to confirm before saving, in case it was a typo.

Calibrating: the first few weeks

When a phase starts you will see **Calibrating** with a countdown. During that time the app is gathering data and proposes no changes: it takes several weeks of weigh-ins for the trend to be reliable. It usually lasts about three weeks, or less if when you activated it you indicated you had already been in the same phase for a while.

Every block change calibrates again, and that is deliberate: going from a bulk to a cut (or the other way round) makes your weight jump because of water and glycogen, which has nothing to do with your fat. Proposing an adjustment on top of that jump would be exactly the opposite of what you need.

The weekly card

This is the only place where the app proposes adjustments, and it appears once a week. It can tell you four things:

- **Keep going:** your rate is on track. Change nothing.
- **Adjust downward:** it opens with the kcal per day to cut and then offers four routes to that same number. The first is to add daily steps, calculated from your data, which for your health and performance is the best one whenever you can manage it; then two diet alternatives — reduce carbohydrates, or carbohydrates and fats, using your foods or the app basics — and the last one combines half activity and half diet. Protein is never cut. Once the phase has built up a high number of recommended daily steps, no more activity is asked for and only the diet route remains.
- **Adjust upward:** increase calories, prioritising carbohydrates. You will never be asked to reduce your activity.
- **Take a break (refeed and deload):** if you have been in a deficit for a long time, the app proposes a couple of days with more carbohydrates, coordinated with a training deload. The scale may go up on those days from water and glycogen: the system ignores that deliberately, so do not panic.

Two rules of use. First: **choose one option only**, do not stack them, and keep it every day until the next card. Second: the figure is an **adjustment relative to your average intake last week**, keeping the same level of activity and training; it is not a target intake nor your maintenance. There is nothing to tick or confirm: keep weighing yourself and the next card will arrive on its own.

Your body fat % and the fat / lean mass split

Below the trend card you have the **body fat %** card: today's estimated figure, how long ago your last measurement was and with which method, the chart with your actual measurements, the estimated curve, the projection for the coming months and a band representing the margin of the estimate.

When you have two measurements far enough apart, the app adds a summary of the **split**: how much of the weight you have changed was fat and how much was lean mass, in kilos. It always says lean mass and not muscle, because in the short term that figure also includes water and glycogen. If the split is not going as it should, the card tells you and can offer to ease off the rate with one tap.

This summary does not always appear. If the interval between measurements is short, if the weight change is small or if you changed measurement method, the app prefers to stay quiet and explain why rather than give you an unreliable reading. The split never modifies your training.

How it coordinates with your training

The nutrition layer and the training engine talk to each other. This is what you will notice:

- **The diet phase stops being a manual selector:** it is set by the current block of your plan, and the progression engine uses it just as before (more cautious in a deficit, slightly more permissive in a surplus).
- **Performance monitor:** the app tracks the level of two or three main lifts. Selection is automatic and prioritises the ones you do early in the session, but you can choose them yourself from the Performance monitor card.
- **Stimulus protection:** if your performance on those lifts falls in a sustained way and the diet adjustment does not fix it, the app reduces the volume of your exercises to protect the stimulus; a little first and, if the drop is confirmed, somewhat more. There is a floor: it never goes below one set per exercise and it does not keep cutting indefinitely. Load can still progress within that reduced volume.
- **Refeed and deload go together:** when the weekly card proposes a break, the training deload already comes coordinated with it.
- **If you change routine,** the monitor recalibrates over a few sessions and tells you so on its card. In the meantime, weight tracking carries on as normal.

Menstrual cycle mode

If your profile declares female sex, the tab offers an optional cycle mode that reduces the effect of the weight fluctuations typical of the cycle. It works from day one assuming a standard length and, as soon as you mark day 1 twice, it switches to your real cycle length. Day 1 is the first day of bleeding, not the day you record it: you can mark a past date, and delete the last mark if you get it wrong. The mark is optional; the mode works without it.

Pausing the phase

For trips, illness or off-routine weeks, you can **pause the phase**: the loop freezes and those days do not count. Your adjustments, refuels and volume protection are preserved. When you resume, the app lets a few days go by and asks for a few weigh-ins before evaluating again, so that it does not read a simple return to normal as progress. Pausing beats abandoning: when you come back, the module picks up where you left it.

Alerts and notifications

The module has exactly **two** local notifications, both off by default and switchable from the tab: a weigh-in reminder at the time you choose, and a notice that your weekly card is available. There are no others, no push notifications and no motivational messages. If you turn one on and it does not arrive, check notification permission in your system settings.

Inside the app you will also see a periodic reminder to estimate your body fat % again. It appears once per cycle: if you ignore it, it does not nag you the next day.

The charts are interactive

The weight and body fat charts can be explored: pinch to zoom, drag horizontally to pan, tap a point to see its date and value, and double tap to go back to the full view.

Deleting your nutrition data

From the tab you can delete all of the module's data — phase, weigh-ins, library and profile — with a double confirmation. Your training is not touched. The module is included in the app's general backup (section 17), so a previous backup lets you recover everything.

Getting the most out of it

- **Weigh yourself daily and always the same way.** It is the only data the module asks of you, and everything else depends on it.
- **Give calibration time.** You will see no suggestions for the first few weeks, and that is correct: without a reliable trend, any adjustment would be guesswork.
- **One adjustment at a time.** Pick a single option from the card and keep it all week. If you change several things at once, you will not know which one worked.
- **Enter your real foods.** The difference between "cut 200 kcal" and "drop 60 g of dry rice" is, in practice, the difference between applying it and not applying it.
- **Update your body fat % when asked,** always with the same method and under the same conditions.
- **If you go travelling, pause the phase** instead of abandoning it.
- **Be patient with the PRO trial.** It lasts 28 days and calibration takes two or three weeks: the loop shows its value over a longer run.

15. Support tools

Plate calculator

Accessible from the dumbbell icon (top). Enter the target weight and the bar weight and it tells you exactly which plates to put on each side, using only the plates you configured as available (including the fractional-plate limitation). If the target cannot be formed exactly, it warns you how much is missing.

Warm-up sets

On the same screen, enter your 1RM for a main exercise and the app proposes a 5-set warm-up ramp (3 mandatory and 2 optional), progressively raising the weight and lowering the repetitions, to reach your working sets without accumulating fatigue.

Rest timer

Already described in the log section: it manages the rest between sets with an audible alarm. You can enable or disable it in the settings (Countdown between sets). While the countdown runs, the app keeps the screen on so you can see the remaining time. And with the floating timer enabled (section 4), the alarm sounds just the same with the screen off or the phone locked, and you can get the rest-complete alert on your smartwatch.

And with the floating timer on (section 4), on Android your rest follows you outside the app in a draggable capsule that takes you back to TrueLift when you tap it.

16. Sharing your training

TrueLift makes it easy to share your progress:

- **Share session:** from the history, it generates an image card with the date, tonnage, total repetitions and the exercise breakdown, with the TrueLift brand and website.
- **Monthly report:** from Progress, create a summary of the month to share or archive.

17. Backup

Your data lives on your phone. To avoid losing it, use the backups (in settings):

- **Export backup:** saves all your information (routine, history and settings) in a file. Keep it in a safe place.
- **Restore:** loads a backup onto another phone or after reinstalling. It replaces all current data with the backup's, so use it carefully.

The backup is also the way to show your training to a coach: export it and send it to them; it contains your routine and your entire history.

18. Recommendations by level

If you are starting out

- Use **Simple linear**: it is the most efficient way to start.
- Prioritize technique and record RIR honestly; that is what makes the progression work.
- Set up your equipment, log your sessions and let the app guide you.

If you are experienced

- When linear progression stalls, switch to **Double progression**.
- It will let you progress more slowly and precisely when simple progression is exhausted and adding weight every week is no longer viable.
- Consider enabling **Top set + back-offs** on the big basics: squeeze one demanding set and accumulate the rest of the volume with margin.
- Enable **auto-regulation** (PRO) and log your daily state, session effort and cardio: the more the engine "sees", the finer it tunes each decision.
- If you combine strength and endurance, log all your cardio with realistic duration and effort: the engine will watch your total load, not just the weights.

19. Frequently asked questions

Do I lose my data if the PRO trial ends? No. Your routine and history are kept; only the advanced features are locked until you buy the PRO version.

Is the PRO version a subscription? It can be or not, you choose. There are three options: subscription (recurring payment), annual payment and lifetime payment (a single payment that never expires and is

equivalent to having it forever). All are managed by Google Play and can be restored on any phone with your Google account.

Why won't it let me change the sets or the RIR? Adjusting sets, RIR, repetitions and rest is a PRO feature. Try it with the free 28 days or unlock it with the purchase.

I can't load the weight it proposes with my plates. Check your equipment settings: 1.25 plates, microloading (the master switch and how many plates you have) and the dumbbell increment. The app only proposes weights loadable with what you specify.

"Last time" shows one session, but the suggestion is based on another. Why? Because that last session cannot anchor the progression: it was a deload session, it was saved on an amber/red day, or it was trained at reduced intensity due to fatigue. The app explains it right below "Last time" and tells you which full-intensity session the suggestion comes from. It is not a bug: it is the engine protecting your references.

What if a machine is busy or broken? Mark the exercise as Unavailable that day. It remains on record in the history, but it doesn't count toward performance, plateaus or progression, and it doesn't spoil your references.

Do I have to use HRV and auto-regulation? No. They are optional. Progression works without them, but it won't have the optimizations provided in the PRO version.

I don't control my diet, what do I set as the phase? Leave it at Maintenance. It is the neutral option.

I've had several sessions without completing the target at the same weight. What will happen? The app detects it: first it warns you that the next attempt is decisive; with PRO it can also try moving the exercise to the first slot of its day (reordering test) in case the block was fatigue from the previous exercises; and if you still can't get out, it proposes a small step back in load to break the block and climb again with momentum. You will not stay stuck indefinitely.

I haven't trained for a few weeks. Do I resume where I left off? The app will suggest resuming with prudence instead of demanding your last weight, and within a few sessions it recalibrates your real level. It is normal that the first sessions are not compared against your history: the engine is "taking references" again.

Why is the increase smaller this time than other times? Because the engine adjusts each increase according to how your last session really went: if it was very demanding (high RPE or just-enough performance), if you are in a deficit or if you didn't log the RIR, it increases with prudence. It is not a fault: it is a sign it is doing its job.

What is the session effort (RPE) for when saving? It is an overall rating from 1 to 10. If you record it, the app uses it to adjust the next increase and monitor your accumulated fatigue. If you don't touch it, it simply doesn't count: the app never makes up a value for you.

My leg hurts. Will everything stop progressing? No. With auto-regulation (PRO), if you indicate the pain region in your daily state, the app only slows the affected exercises: a knee issue doesn't stop your bench press. The same happens with strong localized soreness.

I slept badly last night and my HRV came out low. Will the app hold me back? One isolated bad night doesn't modulate anything: the engine only reacts to the sustained signal (at least two low nights in a row or a multi-day trend). If it is a one-off dip, train normally.

Does cardio affect my weights? It doesn't directly change your strength loads, but it counts as training load: a cardio week far above usual adds to your fatigue signals and, with auto-regulation (PRO), can prompt the app to suggest a deload.

Can I switch from kg to pounds without ruining my history? Yes. The app stores your data internally with full precision and only changes what you see. You can switch between units whenever you want.

Do I have to count calories or write down what I eat? No. The nutrition module does not log meals or macros and has no food database. It only needs your daily weight; the adjustments it proposes are relative to what you already eat.

Can I use TrueLift without the nutrition part? Yes. It is an optional module: if you do not turn it on, the app works exactly as before, the bar has four tabs and the diet phase goes back to being a manual selector.

I have been weighing myself for two weeks and it proposes nothing. That is calibration, and it is intended. Until your trend is reliable no change is proposed; it usually takes about three weeks. The card shows you the countdown.

Today I weigh a kilo more than yesterday, have I gained fat? Almost certainly not. A kilo overnight is water, salt, glycogen or gut contents. That is exactly what trend weight is for: the app ignores the spike and looks at the line.

Why can I not change my body weight in the settings? Because with the nutrition layer on the module governs it from your daily weigh-ins, so it is always up to date. If you turn the module off, the wheel works again.

Why can I not choose the diet phase by hand? Because with the module on the phase comes from the current block of your season planner. Change the plan and the phase changes; without a plan, the module stays at maintenance.

The app has cut my sets, why? Because your performance on the monitored lifts had been falling in a sustained way and the diet adjustment had not fixed it. It is a temporary protection of the stimulus, it has a floor, and load can still progress within that volume. You will see the explanation on the weekly card.

What happens to my nutrition data if I turn the module off or PRO expires? It is kept. It stops governing your phase and your body weight, but weigh-ins, library, profile and plan are still there, and everything reappears when you turn it back on.

The floating timer does not show up. Check three things: that you are on Android (it is not available on iPhone yet), that **Countdown between sets** is on — the floating timer depends on it — and that you granted the Display over other apps permission. Also remember that the capsule hides on purpose while you are inside TrueLift.

Can I get the rest-complete alert on my watch? Yes. Turn on the floating timer and allow TrueLift notifications on your smartwatch: the rest-complete notice will reach your wrist. Because the app separates the running countdown from the final alert into two different channels, you can keep only the second one and have the watch buzz just when it is time to go back to the bar.

20. About the author

TrueLift was created by Rubén Soro. His approach: evidence-based training, with no shortcuts and no hype, so you progress with sound judgement in every session.

Author's website: www.rubensoro.es

App website: www.truelift.es

TrueLift — Train with sound judgement.